



Here's an introduction to Firebug, which is used primarily for debugging client side scripts in real time and reducing development time. It also helps in creating bug-free code that can run across leading browsers seamlessly.

As the world of open source development evolves, debugging code is becoming a complex task. When it comes to browser client-side scripting that needs to be debugged, there are few tools available. This is especially true for runtime debugging on HTML, CSS and JavaScript tags. Firebug is one of the most popular add-ons of Mozilla Firefox for Web development. It is a free and open source plug-in with a BSD licence. Initially written in 2006, Firebug went through numerous updates, making it a favourite tool for Web software developers, as it certainly makes their lives easier.

Modern content management systems (CMS) such as Drupal, Joomla, Wordpress, etc, empower Web development by embedding the client side code within their content entities. This, however, puts a burden on developers, when it comes to debugging the code in scenarios where it works fine on one browser but fails on another. Since CMS systems also add their own payload to the developer's code, the resultant code obviously becomes very hard to debug. Firebug comes in as an essential helping hand in this situation by breaking code pieces into logical chunks on the screen. It introduces

many features which are essential for Web development, such as inspecting HTML elements, debugging, editing, monitoring any website's CSS, HTML, JavaScript etc. At the time of writing, the most recent version of Firebug is 1.11.2 for Firefox 20. It has two major implementations: an extension (add-on) for Mozilla Firefox and Firebug Lite, which is for other browsers.

Why Firebug?

Firebug is a plug-in or add-on to the browser. What this means is that it has the same level of access and control on the Web page being rendered, as that of the browser entity. Firebug runs in the same security context as the browser, which gives it complete control on the objects and DOMs (document object model) created within a Web page.

Due to this, Firebug can perform multiple runtime operations on the client-side code, such as run JavaScript snippets, inspect HTML content, modify style sheets and layouts, etc. Optionally, it can also analyse network usage for a given page. This helps you find out how big the footprint of a page is—including the images and other code resources